of dark legal fictions in view of the history of at least the last five centuries, ever since the dice was loaded against indigenous worldviews.

What makes matters worse is the sense of religiosity with which constitutions are approached in former colonies, almost as if to prove with vengeance their modern, secular and liberal bona fides to their erstwhile colonial masters, and to earn their validation as 'civilised nations of laws'. In short, the message that is being conveyed by the colonialised native is that 'we are no less European/Western/modern/rational and therefore, your equals' instead of saying 'we do not wish to be European/Western, for we are comfortable in our skin and our subjectivities'. It is this deep-seated coloniality and sense of cultural/civilisational inferiority among colonialised natives that has given rise to bizarre creatures, such as 'constitutional patriotism'. Professing allegiance to constitutionalism is understandable; however, it is a reflection of coloniality when constitutional patriots lose sight of what ought to have been or perhaps is the very object of the constitution's protection, namely preservation and perpetuation of indigeneity and its right to agency.

In short, it is a textbook case of missing the forest for the trees, since such constitutional patriotism has no sense of history or consciousness that is rooted in indigeneity. This makes it detrimental to the indigenous worldview since the colonialised constitutional patriot has already bought into Eurocentrism/Western-normativism either consciously or otherwise, thereby turning into an ambassador and evangelist for the coloniality/modernity/rationality complex. That their identity as a member of the indigenous community has been weaponised to act against indigenous consciousness is lost in the incoherent and self-absorbed din of modernity, rationality and constitutional patriotism.

Given that in contemporary nation-states constitutions as documents create multiplier effects by serving as launchpads for mass enforcement of ideas not just on the politico-economic front but also on the larger civilisational canvas, the priority of former colonies must be to first decolonialise this document so that indigeneity finds its rightful place first within its own territory of origin before it can hope to take its rightful place as an equal at the global high table. After all, there is no denying the fact that the effect of contemporary constitutionalism, at least in former colonies, has become such that it is all-pervasive, which is a reflection of its totalising nature given its entrenched coloniality.